

Introduction to PHP

PHP, an acronym for Hypertext Preprocessor, is an HTML embedded scripting language. As a general purpose language, it is used for web development and HTML. Apart from being one of the potent, server-side scripting languages, PHP is also used for creating interactive and dynamic web sites. The basic syntax of PHP is similar to Perl and C. Due to these similarities, PHP is often used with the Apache web server on various operating systems.

In addition to supporting the Internet Server Application Programming Interface (ISAPI), PHP is also used with IIS on Windows. Originally designed for creating dynamic web pages, it has developed as a popular medium for innovative web applications and has helped in developing some command line interface mediums. Rasmus Lerdorf is credited with creating PHP in 1995. Usually, PHP runs on a web server and is available on different operating systems and platforms. Its ability to run on most web servers and operating systems for free has added to its demand and esteem.

PHP has the following benefits:

- Creates advanced user experience based on resources already collected
- Quick solution for large and advanced web sites
- Convenient solutions for e-commerce
- Diverse scopes for creating online tools

According to recent statistical data, PHP is installed on more than 20 million web sites and around 1 million web servers. The source code for PHP is distributed under a license, thus making it easily accessible to users.

1.1. Installation of PHP

There are two ways for installation with Windows. This can be done either manually or by an installer. You require PHP, a web browser and a web server.